To obtain the 1968 voter registration card for **Thomas (Tom) J. Riese**, you must access the historical archives of the **San Francisco Department of Elections**. This document is a "holy grail" for investigators because it requires a **handwritten signature** and provides a verified **residential address** during the exact month of the first Zodiac attack (December 1968).

1. Accessing the 1968 Voter Registration Card
While modern records are digital, 1960s registrations are maintained on **microfilm** or in **bound ledgers**.

- **The Request:** Submit a formal request to the San Francisco Department of Elections for a "Certified Copy of Voter Registration" for **Thomas J. Riese** for the **1968 General Election**.
- **Archival Location:** If the Department of Elections no longer holds the physical 1968 reels, they are transferred to the San Francisco Public Library History Center or the California State Archives in Sacramento.
- **What to Look For:** The 1968 card will include his **handwritten signature**, **date of birth**, **occupation** (e.g., "Property Manager" or "Real Estate"), and **political party affiliation**.

2. Strategic Value: The "December 1968" Address
The first Zodiac murder (Lake Herman Road) occurred on **December 20, 1968**.

- **The "Home Base" Theory:** Investigators look for a suspect who lived in the **Richmond District** or **San Mateo County** at this time.
- **The Riese Timeline:** If Tom Riese's voter card shows him living at the **732 23rd Avenue** property (Wallis Riese's home) or another family rental in the Richmond in late 1968, it places him in the primary Zodiac "mailing zone" from the very beginning of the crime spree.

3. Handwriting Comparison: The "Zodiac Signature"
Forensic document examiners often use voter registration cards as a "known" sample because they are signed under penalty of perjury, ensuring a natural handwriting style.

- **Specific Markers:** Compare Riese's 1968 signature to the **"Z" symbol** and the **handwritten "Zodiac"** signature on the July 1969 letters.
- **The Slant:** Look for the characteristic **erratic slant** and the **spacing between letters**, which in the Zodiac's writing suggested a "printing" style often used by **draftsmen or clerks**.

Document	Data Point	Investigative Use
1968 Voter Card	**Handwritten Signature**	Primary baseline for handwriting analysis.
1968 Voter Card	**Stated Occupation**	Verification of his "Real Estate" or "Surveying" background.
1968 Voter Card	**Exact Address**	Geographic profiling for the first North Bay attacks.